

Ashampoo WinOptimizer 2007

Tweak your Windows



This software takes up the challenge of keeping Windows supercharged. "Cleaning Tools" has sub-options to clean the hard drive, Registry, and all traces of Internet activity. "Tuning Tools" give you full control of auto-start programs and more. "File Tools" is a set of security and privacy tools such as "File Wiper" to irrecoverably delete files. "Tweaking Tools" contains a defragmenter

among others.

For those not comfortable with using the various optimising features separately, there is One-Click Optimization, which safely cleans up stuff at the click of a button. The trial version is available on this

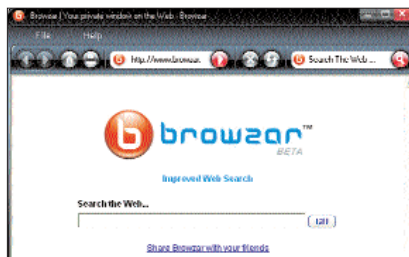
month's CD, and as a bonus, you can register it online to convert it to the full version!

Contact: Ashampoo GmbH & Co. KG
Web site: www.ashampoo.com
Price: Free

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Browzar 2007

A browser for the privacy-conscious



be excruciatingly slow on dial-up connections due to the lack of a cache: when you hit the forward or back buttons, pages need to be reloaded. It doesn't support right-click, so you can't save

Browzar is a free browser that uses the IE shell. A highlight is that it lets you surf with privacy: no cache, history, cookies, or auto-complete!

Browzar is very small—just 264 KB; it comes as an executable that runs solo! You can carry it around on a thumb drive and just start surfing sans privacy concerns. It is very light on system resources, and can therefore be run on even very low-end systems.

Now for the disadvantages: Browzar can

images from Web pages.

Browzar isn't, of course, meant to be a replacement for the standard browsers; its winning points are its portability and privacy.

Web site: www.browzar.com
Price: Free

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Razer Gaming Setup

Only for Razer fans

This gaming kit contains the Copperhead mouse, the Mantis Speed mousepad, and the cable management system a.k.a. Armadillo.

The Mantis is one of the largest mousepads we've ever seen. It is made of Fibertek (a superior cloth weave). The ambidextrous Copperhead has lightning-sharp precision thanks to the 2000 dpi laser engine, the 1 ms response time, the 32 KB of onboard memory that is used to store personal game settings like sensitivity and button mapping (there are five profiles available), and a 16-bit data path (compared to the 8 and 12 bits used by other mice). With sensitivity settings adjustable on the fly by way of two buttons, from 400 to 2000 dpi, the Copperhead quickly adapts to a variety of games from twitch-reaction ones such as

Quake III to RTS games such as Warcraft III.

The mouse feels extremely light—the Logitech G5 feels much more substantial. The Copperhead will require you to curl your fingers constantly to use the buttons. Also, the Copperhead has an "illuminated anti-slip ridge" on each side—these can be uncomfortable for people with larger hands, and tend to dig into your palm after a while. The G5 in comparison fits the contours of the hand perfectly. We used the Copperhead and the G5 on the same surface, and found both the mice equal in terms of performance. It comes down to comfort levels, and there are no doubts as to who's ahead.

The Armadillo is a heavy, metal assembly that can accommodate your

keyboard and mouse cables to prevent them doing a jig around your table. For the Razer cultists, if you need a good gaming mouse for those frag sessions, the Copperhead will do wonders for your aim and accuracy. Non-gamers who haven't been addressed so far... avoid being bitten by the Copperhead bug!

Specifications

Razer Copperhead: 2000 dpi laser sensor, 1000 Hz / 1 ms response time, 32 KB onboard memory, 4 extra programmable buttons



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Comfort	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Razer (Asia-Pacific)
Pte Ltd
Phone: 00-65-6224335
E-mail: terence@razerzone.com
Web site: www.razerzone.com
Price: Copperhead: \$69.99; Armadillo: \$19.99, Mantis-Speed: \$21.99